EJ FOX



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PROFILE

Design engineer and creative technologist who ships under pressure. I transform complex information into clear interactive visuals and have fun doing it. My work combines journalistic curiosity with an addiction to trying new things—from NBC's election graphics to experimental embedding interfaces. I want to make things no one has seen before with smart, kind people. When someone hands me a mess, I take a kind of pathological joy in untangling it.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Code: JavaScript, Python, Node.js, Vue, React, TypeScript, HTML/CSS, SQL

Graphics: D3, Observable Plot, Three.js, WebGL, Canvas, SVG, TopoJSON

AI/ML: LLM APIs, embedding visualization, context management, vector databases, prompt engineering, tool usage, alternative interfaces

Design & Motion: Illustrator, Photoshop, Final Cut Pro, After Effects, Principle, Figma, Animation (GSAP, Anime.js)

Methods: Rapid prototyping, joy-driven development, component systems, public documentation, performance optimization, video demos

EXPERIENCE

Lenfest AI Fellow

Arizona State University NEWSWELL | 2025 - 2026

The Lenfest Institute's AI Collaborative and Fellowship Program, hosted at ASU and supported by OpenAI and Microsoft

- I built a tool that uses AI to lay out the ads and stories in small local print newspapers
- I gave an Ignite talk about it at ASU's National Journalism + AI Accelerator in January 2026

Design Engineer & Creative Technologist

Independent Consultant | 2019 - Present

Select Clients: GitHub • NBC News • CBS News • Washington Post • New York Times • Carnegie Mellon • Stamen

- I take the tight-deadline projects that need short sprints and real user testing, especially things no one has built before
- I helped CBS News prototype its broadcast touchscreen app, analyzed newspaper front pages for the New York Times, and made geographic visualizations with the geniuses at Stamen.
- I work between design and engineering, in whatever stack the client already has, from brand-new startups to big companies with their own process
- I work in public when I can. There are 50+ Observable notebooks, plus livestreams on YouTube and blog posts about what I'm making and how.

Founder

Room 302 Studio | 2023 - Present

Select Clients: The Associated Press • Wildlife Conservation Society • Earth Genome

- My prototyping shop for new kinds of data visualization and analysis, usually on tight deadlines
- I built the studio's manager on top of an LLM. It's our 'AI team member'
- We turn rough ideas into demos good enough for a client to show their bosses or take to a funder

- I worked with the Associated Press team on its 2024 election coverage, which was nominated for a Webby.
- I helped the Wildlife Conservation Society map coral reefs that are holding up against climate change and tell their story

Contractor

Stamen Design | 2020 - 2022

- I made geographic visualizations with the Stamen team

Senior Interactive Graphics Specialist

NBC News | 2016 - 2019

- I was lead designer on the 2018 relaunch of the election-night Big Board and built it with Michael Small and the NBC News Digital teams. The New York Times called it "newly juiced-up." It's still in use today.

Graphics Editor

Vocativ | 2014 - 2016

- I automated enough of the desk to go from five graphics a month to five a day
- I led the winning Knight Foundation grant pitch for Dataproofer, a tool that checks datasets for errors
- I gave reporters a visualization platform they could use on their own, made the templates, and ran daily breaking-news graphics

Early Career

- *GitHub (2013)*: I worked with the GitHub team on the "State of the Octoverse" site and its visualizations
- *Visual.ly (2011)*: I was on the core team that built one of the first visualization-as-a-service platforms

AWARDS

Knight Prototype Fund grant (Knight Foundation, 2015): For Dataproofer, with Gerald Rich and the Vocativ data team.

PROJECTS

Subway Builder, 2025 - 2026. Colin Miller's subway-building game. He was in Room 302 Studio and brought me on as his first developer. One of the lead developers. I built the desktop version for the July 2026 Steam launch.

Decision Desk HQ, 2025. I helped design and build the tools broadcasters use to show election results

Global Energy Ownership Tracker · Global Energy Monitor, 2025 - 2026. I helped build an explorer of who owns the world's energy assets, with ownership trees, embeddable cards and a screener

Paramilitary Leaks, 2025. I built an explorer and visualizations for 200 GB of leaked militia chats. Micah Lee cited it in his reporting.

NYPD misconduct network · WNYC/Gothamist, 2021. I did the network analysis of civilian complaint records for an investigation into clusters of officers accused of misconduct again and again

Climate TRACE · Earthrise Media, 2022. I made maps and data exploration tools for emissions sources around the world

Ukraine grain · Earth Genome, 2022. A scrolling data story about global food security

COVIDcast · Carnegie Mellon University Delphi, 2020. I prototyped visualizations for the public COVID-19 indicators, July to September 2020

Election simulator · Washington Post Opinions, 2019. I helped build an election simulator on top of David Byler's model

Dark-money map · Mother Jones, 2012. I co-authored an interactive map of the super PAC and dark-money universe

NBC News Specials · NBC News, 2016 - 2019. Bespoke longform features, built on the Foundry team in collaboration with reporters.

Dataproofer · Vocativ, 2015 - 2016. An open source tool to check data for reliability, funded by a Knight Prototype Fund grant, with Gerald Rich and the Vocativ data team.

Long Lead · Long Lead, 2021 - 2022. Production and technical work for a story studio that builds each long-form feature from scratch.

The Margin · The Margin, 2022. Data storytelling for an independent outlet covering the people and places most affected by environmental injustice.

Terminal Tools, 2026. Fourteen small programs for the terminal: utilities for working inside tmux, a few input and display experiments, and some games and toys.

Amen Slicer, 2026. A breakbeat slicer / performance instrument for the Game Boy Advance.

Pixel Canvas, 2026. A networked 320×240 display that sits on my desk.

Vulpes Browser, 2026. Minimalist web browser. Zig + Swift + Metal, rendered entirely on the GPU, with particle effects, link glow, and a two-pass bloom.

Vulpes Devices, 2026. One palette, one glyph, generated out to seven device targets.

Vulpino, 2026. Any JSON endpoint into a home-screen iOS widget, no code, in about a minute.

Tempo, 2026. A brutalist Pomodoro timer for iPhone and Apple Watch.

cyberdeck-saver, 2026. A native macOS screensaver, written in Swift.

GitHub Sloth, 2026. A minimalist amber-on-black terminal UI for GitHub PRs, reviews, and checks, written in Rust.

Connectology, 2026. A custom front-end replacement for Gephi or a raw D3 force layout.

Coach Artie Memory Analysis, 2026. What does an AI agent actually remember? I embedded all of it, clustered it, and drew the map.

OpenRouter Census, 2025. A full census of every model on OpenRouter, dumped into immutable JSONL/Parquet snapshots and rendered as an Observable Plot dashboard.

WebSDR VCV, 2025. A VCV Rack / Cardinal plugin that streams real radio from KiwiSDR servers into a modular synth.

NOAA Satellite CLI, 2025. The whole planet, from a satellite, on your hard drive, in one command.

Obsidian Analysis, 2024. I embedded my entire Obsidian vault, around 2,000 notes, using local Nomic embeddings.

Hand-Tracking & Generative Art, 2024. Attempts to make computers that respond to the way humans actually move and gesture.

Coach Artie, 2023. The AI assistant that lives in the Room 302 Studio Discord. He came online in March 2023.

Twitter Artbot, 2017. My first generative art bot. It ran hourly from June 2017 to late 2019, on its own.